

Civilization gets a sequel

Sci-fi bestseller Civilization: Beyond Earth expands its reach; sets out to the oceans.
<http://dgit.in/1Hp1Hw5>

Hololens is back!

Microsoft's Hololens is back. does it have what it takes to be a winner?
<http://dgit.in/1PuFLXo>

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the former's garbage collection process. Android's overall efficiency depends on how its unused memory, freed up after an app is closed, is recycled into the usable memory pool. Android tends to stack this unused memory for a time after which it recycles it wholesale and in order to do that, it needs a large quantity of free, usable memory without which the recycling process slows down the entire system. Both the Dalvik Runtime (default in Android phones before Lollipop) and ART runtime (default in Lollipop era phones) use similar, non-compacting garbage collection methods, so the above issue will remain and you need Android devices with greater RAM storage.

The Solution: Google has tied up with some manufacturers to give consumers and the market an idea of what the ideal and minimum Android device should be with programs such as Nexus and Android One.

With respect to the garbage collection process, the reason Android sticks with this system is that this process saves the app's state, theoretically letting you conserve your battery life. That said, AOSP (Android Open Source Project) is working on a compacting garbage collector for ART that improves Android's RAM management and this needs to be integrated into the OS by default.

In Android 5.1, Google has also allowed app devs to choose between performance and battery life by letting apps spread their functions to all cores in a multi-core processor.

The Tablet problem

Apart from a few Galaxy Tab variants from Samsung and the Nexus tablets, most large screened Android devices fall into the phablet category. However, the continued popularity of the iPad, and Microsoft's renewed focus on the tablet/laptop hybrid category, prove that people are looking for devices with 7-inch and larger displays.

The iPad today is being used in multiple fields and it seems strange that Android manufacturers have stayed away from the fray. Sure, tablet sales are falling but the segment continues to remain an important one and Microsoft's efforts could give it a shot in the arm.

The Solution: If Google believes in the potential of the tablet segment, then it needs to take a more active role in promoting Android as a tablet OS perhaps by tying up with trusted device manufacturers as it did with Android One.

It should also develop more tablet exclusive apps that have clear content creation and productivity uses and encourage top of the line developers to do the same. iOS beats it hands down here.



The 'Too Big to Fail' Problem

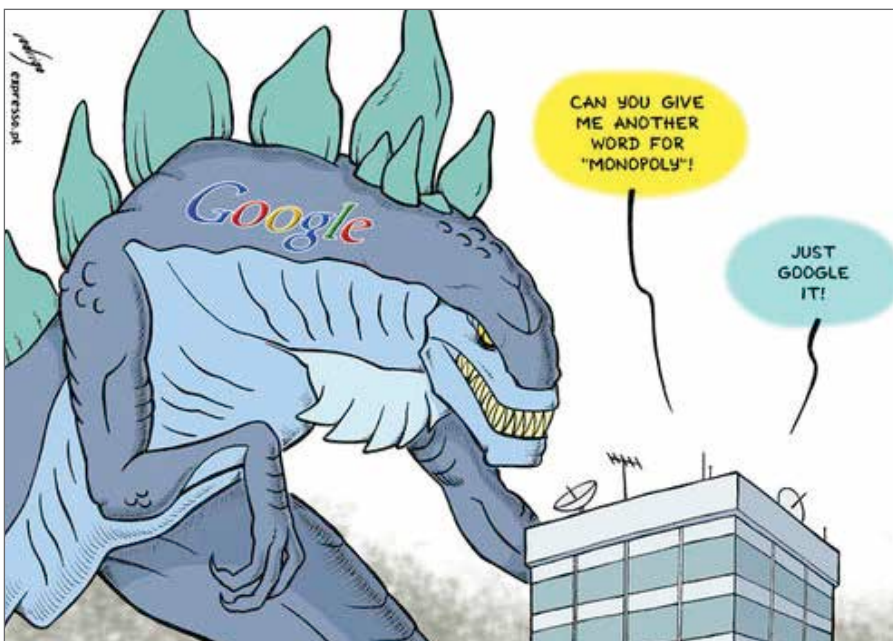
Just like Microsoft, Google too has fallen into the bad books of the EU and now faces anti-trust allegations. There is some validity in those allegations though, because even without Android, Google held a monopoly on the search engine market.

There are plenty of other players in the search market, but none of them are as good as Google and of course, Google holds a monopoly here. The new allegations focus on pre-installed Google apps on Android but Google has said that its hardware partners are free to install any apps on their devices, not just Google's.

If the EU manages to prove its allegations in court, then Google may be prevented from pre-installing any of its suite of apps on Android devices, forcing them to give users a choice from the get-go.

The Solution: Analysts suggest that Google may 'open-up' its apps to competitors in order to beat the anti-trust charges.

Luckily for Google, this isn't a problem that Google faces alone as both Microsoft and Apple are also in the same boat and even if Google is forced to comply with EU regulations regarding bundled apps, so will Microsoft and Apple. 



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